KARL AUGUST MÖBIUS

1825–1908

A German pioneer, Möbius was primarily interested in the ecology of marine ecosystems. After studying at the Natural History Museum of Berlin, and earning a Ph.D. at the University of Halle, he opened a seawater aquarium in Hamburg in 1863. While a professor of zoology at the University of Kiel, his work on the viability of commercial oyster production in the Bay of Kiel led him to recognize the various dependent relationships between organisms in the oyster bank ecosystem.

See also: The ecosystem

ERNST HAECKEL

1834–1919

Haeckel was a biologist, physician, and artist who popularized Charles Darwin's ideas in Germany (while also rejecting many of them) and introduced the word "ecology" in 1866. Born in Potsdam, he studied at several universities before becoming a zoology professor at the University of Jena in 1861. Haeckel was the first biologist to propose the kingdom *Protista*—for organisms that are neither animal nor vegetable—and he researched and painstakingly recorded tiny deep-sea protozoans called radiolaria.

See also: Evolution by natural selection

WILLIAM BLAKE RICHMOND

1842–1921

Best known as a British artist, sculptor, and designer of stained glass and mosaics, London-born Richmond became an environmental activist after having to endure the poor light and smoky air produced by London's winter